



Wave no more

Google announced this month that it would stop development of its Wave even though it would be live till the end of year

Rupee symbol on Lava B5

Lava B5 mobile which has an alpha keyboard will ship with the new Rupee symbol

Apacer AL670

Versatile HD media player

There is a deluge in the HD media players market which has reached to an extent where manufacturers are going beyond plain vanilla video viewing and are offering incentives. Apacer AL 670 is a media player which also packs in a video streaming feature from a local PC and it can be used as a BitTorrent client.

The flat top with a brush metal finish makes it look quite impressive. On the front you have two USB ports, a power button and the IR receiver. The range of connectivity options like HDMI out, LAN port, AV ports are located on the rear side. User interface of the player

has a circular trajectory with the regular options like music, movies, photo, online and settings.

Navigating through the menus is quite straightforward. The remote is sturdy with well placed buttons. The circular nav pad can be used to increase/decrease the size of the subtitles and move it up or down. It takes over 10 seconds to start up, but from then on it is quite snappy. Movies section has a preview mode, which plays the movie in a small rectangle as soon as you select it. You can go to the home menu while a live movie / audio is playing. Resume playback is a nice option which



allows you to playback movies, if you had stopped them abruptly.

We played all movie resolutions including 480p, 720p and 1080p and formats from .AVI to .MKV to even .RMVB. Quality of video playback is quite good, but 480p videos appeared somewhat below quality. You can change the setup like aspect ratio, controls etc. Audio playback was good in the mid-range frequencies.

At ₹7,999 we feel that the AL 670 is a very decent buy.

Specifications

External USB drive support; Connectivity : LAN port, HDMI port, Composite video port; Aspect Ratio support : 4:3, 16:9, 16:10; File types: .AVI, .MKV, .RMVB etc.

Contact

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Price: ₹7,999

7.0/10

Features 7.0
Performance 7.0
Build Quality 6.5
Value for money 7.0

Iomega ScreenPlay TV Link Director

Sleek HD performer

Specifications

AV connections : HDMI, Composite video and audio R/L; Aspect Ratio support : 4:3, 16:9, 16:10; Video formats : MPEG-1, MPEG-2, MPEG-4, H.264

Contact

Iomega

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Price: ₹7,300

On first glance one may mistake the Iomega ScreenPlay Tv Link Director for a portable hard drive thanks to its slim form factor and the beautiful black brush metal finish on the top surface. But a bunch of ports on the rear side bring home the realization that this is an HD media player. On the rear you have the HDMI port. It takes around 10 seconds to start up. Home screen comprises the menus Music, Movies, Photos, Online and Settings arranged one below the other. You have to search for your media format as there is no provision to club



movies, music and photos. Navigation is simplified thanks to the user friendly remote control. ScreenPlay also has an option to connect to the internet and pull in videos from YouTube or act as a BitTorrent client.

Video output across all formats was great and we did not notice any skipping of video. Music playback was decent.

Photo slideshow experience was not that great as the output tended to wash out. One setback we noticed in the player was that it tended to heat a lot, even when used for 30 minutes.

Priced at an economical ₹7,300 it is ideal for those who travel a lot and would always like to keep their HD videos viewable on any TV.

6.5/10

Features 7.0
Performance 6.5
Build Quality 6.0
Value for money 6.5